

Nadia Quill

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

You were preparing a major investigation into Sterling's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

What you are hiding

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Find out whether Sterling found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
- Keep your source's identity protected.
- Get Grant or Conrad to comment on the Geneva records without telling them what you know.

What you know about other guests

- Grant is vulnerable over a disputed authenticity certificate in an old private sale.
- Helena wrote a much harsher legal opinion on the Star Bowl before a softer version appeared.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

You slipped into the Donor Salon at 6:31 hoping to interview Sterling and left when he refused. From 6:40 to 6:49, the Press Room scanner records you copying the confidential source documents behind your embargoed story. The scan log clears your timing but risks exposing how much internal material you possess.

IF MURDERER

At 6:47 you returned after Sterling threatened your source. You poisoned his cordial and then wrote a false earlier timestamp in your notebook to create distance from the salon.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

My source gave me documents Sterling desperately wanted buried. I went into his salon earlier to confront him, and I refused to name the source when he threatened me. The Press Room scanner log shows me copying those documents throughout the poisoning window. Protecting a source made me secretive, not murderous.

IF MURDERER

Sterling could survive the story. My source could not survive being exposed by him. I went back, poisoned his cordial, and falsified my notebook timeline. Journalists are supposed to protect sources without becoming the story. I failed that rule spectacularly.